



Markhor
(*Capra falconeri*)
Body length: up to 5 ft 7 in (1.7 m)
Tail: up to 7.8 in (20 cm)

Corkscrew horns

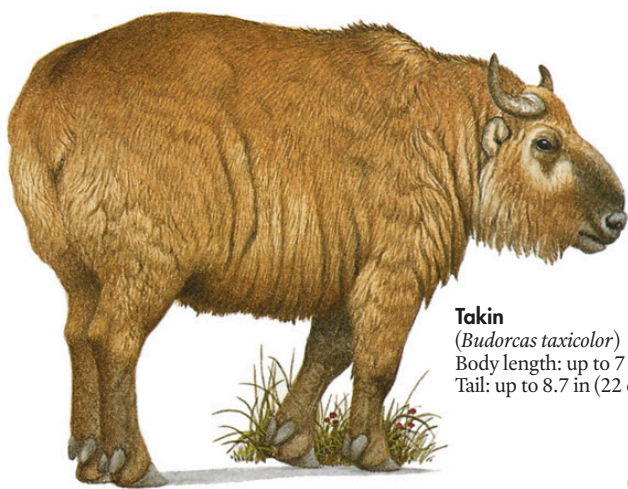
The markhor is a wild goat with huge curly horns that can grow up to 4 ft (1.2 m) long. Male and female animals both have horns, but the female's are smaller. The markhor's coat is short and smooth in summer but grows longer in winter to keep out the cold. It also moves down the mountains to find warmer places in winter. Once nearly extinct, markhor numbers are now increasing again.



Winter sleep

The Himalayan marmot hibernates in its burrow in winter. They live in groups. One always stands guard to warn the others of any danger. Marmots feed on plants and come out in the early morning to find food.

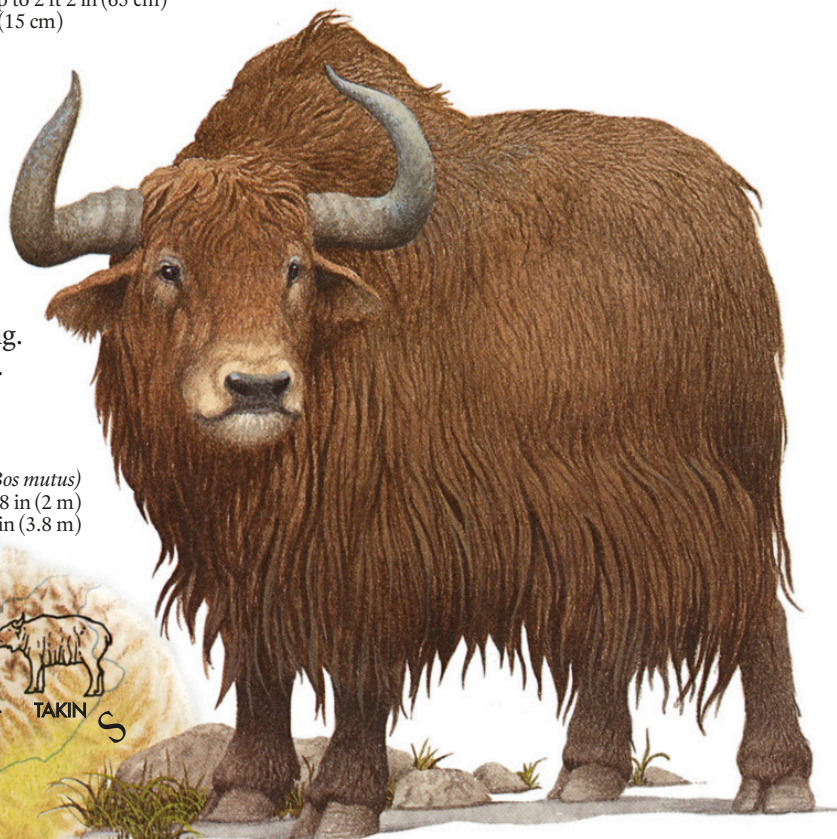
Himalayan marmot
(*Marmota himalayana*)
Body length: up to 2 ft 2 in (65 cm)
Tail: up to 6 in (15 cm)



Takin
(*Budorcas taxicolor*)
Body length: up to 7 ft 2 in (2.2 m)
Tail: up to 8.7 in (22 cm)

Sturdy legs

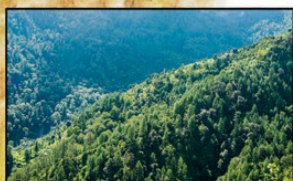
The takin has thick, strong legs and large hooves, which help it climb the steep slopes. In summer, herds live high up the mountains in rhododendron and bamboo thickets. In winter, they move down to the valleys. Young takin can follow their mother over the slopes at just three days old.



Yak (*Bos mutus*)
Height at shoulder: up to 6 ft 8 in (2 m)
Body length: up to 12 ft 6 in (3.8 m)

Furry fringe

The yak has a very long, furry coat that reaches almost to the ground. Under the long hairs is a layer of short, dense underfur, which insulates the yak from the freezing winter temperatures. It molts this underfur in the spring. The yak is nimble, despite its size. It lives in the Tibetan plateau, in grasslands, tundra, and desert.



Trees on the mountainsides soak up rain and help hold the soil together.

Bone stripper

The harsh life in the mountains provides a plentiful supply of dead animals for the huge Himalayan griffon vulture to eat. A group of these vultures can strip a small animal, such as an antelope, to the bone in only 20 minutes.

Fire bird

The fire-tailed myzornis has red markings on its wings and tail, making it look as if it is on fire. This tiny bird lives in the evergreen mountain forests of Nepal. It feeds on insects, spiders, berries, tree sap, and nectar, which it laps up with its bristly tongue.



Fire-tailed myzornis
(*Myzornis pyrrhura*)
Wingspan: up to 5 in (13 cm)



Himalayan black bear
(*Ursus thibetanus laniger*)
Body length: up to 6 ft 3 in (1.9 m)

Moving bear

The Himalayan black bear lives in the forests on the lower slopes of the mountains. It can climb well and is a good swimmer. Sometimes it curls into a ball and rolls downhill. During winter months, it moves to the foothills where food is available year round.



Himalayan griffon vulture
(*Gyps himalayensis*)
Wingspan: up to 9 ft 6 in (2.9 m)